

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

stacker.news
weekly zine



it's quite dusty in here



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SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

another one

stacker news zine is a weekly publication of the best facts and fictions from your favorite pay-2-post bitcoin-only forum

made by @plebpoet
with support from @k00b

we like
bitcoin

but we love
freedom
more

note from the editor

i was approached today with an amazing opportunity.
i am happy to announce that my beloved cat will be crowned pet of the month.
so things are goin pretty well.



This post



Medium article
referenced by
this post

Transforming animation with machine learning

top boost

1264 sats \ 10k boost \ 10 comments \

@ek 9 nov gaming

I've been reading a lot of good stuff about [ARC Raiders](#).

In fact, I read and watched so many people recommending the game that I was sure most of them were getting paid to hype it, and that it was probably just another extraction shooter.

However, when I dug deeper into why people like the game, I found that **the enemies aren't traditionally animated, but are instead physically-based AI agents:**

> *How we overhauled our animation workflow with machine learning, teaching physically-based AI-agents to walk on their own instead of animating movement.*

Animation is a big bottleneck in all game development. Characters or creatures have to be designed and scripted manually, to achieve seemingly realistic interactions with the world. That makes it hard to achieve scale without growing your game team.

So over the past two years, we've continued down the path of physical animation based on [reinforcement learning](#). In short, that means we train physically-based machines to walk by giving them rewards for doing the right things – like virtual dog treats.

As you'll see in the examples below, achieving good movement behaviors can lead to more immersive and interesting gameplay, where the world becomes truly alive – where there aren't any pre-made animations, stuttering transitions between poses, or weird ragdolls.

*Instead our agent – you can think of it as the AI player – observes its body and the world around it; and decides how to move the legs over the next few frames. **This means that if the agent collides, is hit by, or generates some force by itself; it can adapt immediately for each unique situation.** If you trip on a rock or get hit by a snowball you'll do something unique every time – because no snowball or rock is the same.*

My emphasis cannot be overstated. This makes shooting the enemies extremely satisfying. Action sequences that other games have to script and still feel underwhelming, this game just has them out of the box during every encounter. The enemies are probably also intentionally robots to be even more immersive. If they were human, it would be much harder to make them feel real.

If you're on the edge about trying this game, really, give it a try.

I think I just witnessed a revolution in gaming.

no, I'm not getting paid to say this

top post



10.2k sats \ 66 comments \ @k00b 9 nov meta

tldr

- sorry i deleted your profile images. you'll need to reupload them
- if you have CCs, you will save more sats and spend CCs more often now
- territory revenue is paid out when the action is paid for, ie immediately
- statistics has autistic (ie excellent) levels of detail about how you're spending and earning money
- every payment on the SN has a transaction page, and if you're involved in the transaction, you can see relevant details about your involvement in the transaction (click on a row in statistics to check it out)
- payment retries are less buggy
- zap retries fallback to CCs automatically if the receiver's wallet fails enough times
- the analytics pages, for the site, territories, and your account, have more detail (and much more will come soon that isn't exposed in the gui yet)



statistics

what

My first professional mentor taught me that "no one cares how you did it, just what it does." My goal with this release was to upgrade SN's guts while maintaining parity otherwise. Some advantages of the new guts can be experienced immediately, but the main what of this change is easing system malleability by an order or two of magnitude.

what it does so far

1. territory revenue is paid to the territory founder immediately, when the transaction happens
2. you can now pay for things on SN with mixed assets, e.g. if your post costs 100 sats and you have 20 CCs and 50 reward sats you'll only need to pay a 30 sat invoice noncustodially
3. depending on where the splits are sent, we can use a different, preferred asset for each destination, e.g. if you're zapping someone 100 sats and have 30 CCs, the CCs are used to pay the sybil fee, and you only pay a 70 sat invoice noncustodially
4. statistics records not only how much of which asset you spent or earned on an action, but also the effect of the spending or earning on each "asset" balance. Basically, at a glance, you can audit that things are working as you expect them to.
5. Every payment, aka transaction, has a transaction page with a visualization of the incoming asset splits and the outgoing destinations. Again, at a glance, you can audit that things are working as you expect them to.

what it will do over time

1. this micropayment engine is agnostic to the payment method. previously we assumed all payments would use bolt11s, but we can now add bolt12 and possibly even onchain payments without hacks or other dysfunction.
2. we'll be able to fine tune the incentives and side effects of existing behaviors to better fit with what we learn over time
3. we can make better use of CCs to get you more sats
4. we can make noncustodial splits while maintaining our existing retry UX
5. we can add new payment and earning related experiments with relative ease

why

1.-7. (scan this post's QR to read this section because it's too long for me to include)

Put together, this means that we need to remember a lot of non-payment things in relationship to our payments, do detailed accounting, retry payment failures, make arbitrary and numerous fine adjustments to the effects of payments depending on the context, refund money when we don't get what we pay for, and anticipate and respond to payment events weeks in the future. Automatically.

That's what this thing I call a micropayment engine aims to do. I think of the requirements like an N-set venn diagram and the micropayment engine is the middle where they all overlap.



visual source



sorry

1. As a result of this change, I accidentally deleted all of your profile images. When we delete things, we try to delete them as deeply and permanently as possible for the sake of your privacy, and it appears I've shot us in our feet. You'll need to reupload them.
2. The site speed has been sluggish for the last few weeks, a dimension I neglected while working on these changes. These changes in many ways worsen performance, but I'll be tuning things over the week and things should be back up to snuff soon.
3. We've neglected most nonwallet and nonpayment dimensions of the site. Using bitcoin The Right Way is hard and a lot of what we're doing is on a weird little bleeding edge no one yet cares about. We've been having to invent stuff and learn the hard way as we go. This change is intended to encapsulate the wallet and payment stuff we've learned and get it out of the way so that we can move fast on the stuff that matters again.

what's next

1. I'm going to be fine tuning the performance of the micropayments engine and fixing all the bugs I introduced
2. Broadly, my next mission is to greatly simplify and reduce the complexity of the site. . .
3. ek is getting some R&R, so give him a break would ya
4. sox is preparing a grandmother f'ing amazing upgrade to the editor which we have plans for that you probably wouldn't believe if I told ye and i want to keep secret for extra mindblow factor



Hey kid, you wanna buy some blockspace?

You've probably heard about so-called "transaction acceleration services" like [MARA's Slipstream](#) and <https://mempool.space/accelerator>. Such services allow you to "accelerate" a transaction by paying the service provider an extra fee to mine your transaction in their next block.

Pretty much all the big pools except Foundry and Ocean have made such transaction accelerator services available to the public:

- [Antpool txAccelerate](#)
- [SpiderPool txAccelerate](#)
- [ViaBTC BTC Transaction Accelerator](#)
- [f2pool Transaction Accelerator](#)
- [Mara Slipstream](#)
- [Mempool Accelerator](#)

It's interesting to note that Slipstream is the only acceleration service that actually lets you submit a transaction that has not yet been broadcast. I have a feeling many of these other services would allow something similar, but they don't have it formalized on their websites.

Transaction accelerators are bad, 'mkay

In the course of the debate about filters, an increased use of such acceleration services has been suggested as one possible outcome of stricter relay policies. This, in turn, is suggested as a source of increased miner centralization.

The argument goes that if people find that broadcasting their transaction to the relay network does not result in it getting mined into a block, they may consider using an accelerator. However, small miners may not have the ability to operate a transaction acceleration service, and even if they do, they probably won't have the same kind of reach to get such a service in front of the public, and so widespread use of accelerators could result in large miners collecting even more fees and growing even larger.

"there would be no harm to system security even if all fees were paid off chain"

Eric Voskuil has an interesting take on this theory. He argues that such "side-fee" arrangements (also called "out of band") do not change the fee market:

- > *If the arrangement deviates from market rates then either the miner or the merchant is accepting an unnecessary loss. This is no different than the miner confirming transactions with below-market on-chain fees or the merchant overestimating on-chain fees, respectively.*

At first, I didn't find this argument very convincing. If use of such accelerators is widespread it could likely resemble consistent "overestimation" of on-chain fees, which seems to me that it would be a difference in the market.

However, that may not actually be the case. Imagine you submitted a transaction at 5 sats/vB and it just languishes in mempools and doesn't get confirmed. This implies that new transactions are appearing with higher fee rates and taking up all the space in newly mined blocks...or that miners are choosing to forgo the profit they could make from mining your transaction in order to mine less valuable transactions.

Nevertheless, you decide to submit your transaction to an accelerator and pay them an extra fee. If this fee, combined with the internal fee of your transaction, is less than the prevailing rate making it into blocks, the miner will clearly be taking a loss. If it is more than the prevailing rate making it into blocks, you probably should just have offered that fee-rate to begin with or RBF'd it yourself.

And if this is the case with one transaction, I don't see why it wouldn't be the case with many. If a "prevailing fee rate" can be estimated from looking at mempools and previous blocks, then any deviation from this fee rate will likely come at extra cost either to the miner or to the person who wants their transaction confirmed.

Prohibition, War on Drugs, Mempool Filters

For a transaction accelerator to sustain their service at rates below what they could get by selecting transactions from mempools would pretty quickly result in that miner losing money and not being competitive.

But the real question is what happens if a transaction accelerator is able to sustain higher than market fee rates collected by their service.

In the context of the filter debate, transaction accelerators may receive higher than market fee rates because people can't get their transactions confirmed any other way. But this implies that at least 92% of the network is refusing to relay such transactions (<https://stacker.news/items/1244876>)...a situation that seems very difficult to maintain for the case of transactions with sustained economic demand.

continued

Voskuil makes the argument that such a situation is indistinguishable from a state subsidy of mining. He allows that it would distort the mining landscape, but does not see it as a problem inherent to side fee arrangements, but rather to the root cause which makes such a situation possible.

In our example, sustained above-market fees for certain transactions collected by transaction accelerators are potentially caused by aggressive filtering of transactions by more than 92% of the relay network. This presents, I think, another way of describing the idea of filtering transactions via the relay network: it's a way of subsidizing miners who are willing to mine such transactions.

Perhaps you recall how the US waged a War on Drugs during the 1990s or the Prohibition Era in the 1920s. These aggressive campaigns to "filter" things out of society likely had the result of enriching the people who were willing to break the law.

Think about how it plays out in the competitive world of mining.

I've been reading Cryptoeconomics again, and this is an attempt to work through some of the ideas in the chapter called "Side Fee Fallacy" which I am copying here:

Side Fee Fallacy

There is a theory that off-chain fees are illegitimate. The theory holds that a merchant paying a miner "on the side" to confirm the merchant's transactions prevents other merchants' transactions from being confirmed, or that it raises the cost of those confirmations.

One impact of such arrangements is that an average historical fee rate cannot be determined through chain analysis. The apparent rate would be lower than the market rate. This could of course lead spenders to underestimate a sufficient fee.

However there is no aspect of Bitcoin that requires future fees to equal some average of past fees. Estimation necessarily compensates, such as by ignoring "free" transactions in full blocks or using standard deviation to identify outliers.

Another impact is that disparate relative fee levels can highlight certain transactions as being associated with such arrangements. This can contribute to taint of the merchant's transaction and/or the miner's coinbase. But given the arrangement is a choice made by the creators of these transactions, there is no privacy loss.

There is no impact on market fee rates or the ability of others to obtain confirmations. If the arrangement deviates from market rates then either the miner or the merchant is accepting an unnecessary loss. This is no different than the miner confirming transactions with below-market on-chain fees or the merchant overestimating on-chain fees, respectively.

Furthermore, unless the miner's hash power is 100%, the merchant is increasing his/her average confirmation times by paying a side-fee at what is otherwise a market rate. This implies that the market rate for side fees is the product of the miner's hash power and the prevailing market rate. In other words, proportionally less than otherwise on-chain market rates. Without this understanding one may misinterpret the actual effective rate in such arrangements.

Bitcoin provides a mechanism for on-chain fees so that a transaction can compensate any miner without the use of identity. It is a privacy-preserving convenience. If miners and merchants want to weaken their privacy by performing additional tasks, there is no basis to consider that illegitimate. This theory is therefore invalid.

There is a related theory that side fee arrangements constitute a pooling pressure. If fees paid are consistent with the market there can be no effect on pooling. Above market fees are a state subsidy, as we must treat the subsidy is not economically rational. Below market fees are a tax, as we must treat the loss as involuntary. These are distortions just like any other state subsidy/tax and are therefore not unique to side fees. As such the existence of side fees does not create a new pooling pressure and the theory is therefore invalid.



891 sats \ 19 comments \

@pappasbland 12 nov bitcoin

You won't believe the synergy here. I am doing some part-time work with a local firewood business who specialize in providing ultra kiln-dried wood, crafted for cleaner flames, longer-lasting burns, and maximum heat efficiency. I'm on the stacking team, so I show up to an address and help stack the logs where the homeowner wants them. Or sometimes I'll help stack the wood into the truck for deliveries, like I did today. This income is exclusively going into Bitcoin. So I'm stacking wood to stack sats. I'm stacking in such a literal sense that it's kind of hilarious. Does anyone else stack in the real world?

-Tom

comments

61 sats \ 0 replies \ @oneoneseven 12 nov

Fond memories of chopping wood in the winter for our wood stove as a kid.

Before enlightenment, chop wood, carry water. After enlightenment, chop wood, carry water

40 sats \ 1 reply \ @earthcoin 13 nov



I like how you arrange them nicely in the truck. Seems that you are a well organized man.

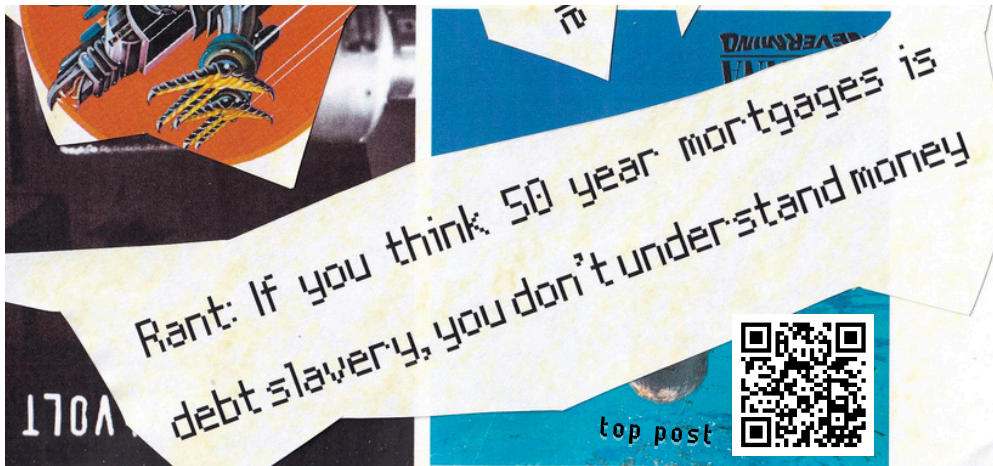
I stack beer cans for building a house walls :)

Read more here:
#1256615

40 sats \ 1 reply \ @sha256man 12 nov

i am making stacks of sauerkraut jars...
it's gonna be a lot of sauerkraut;





3162 sats \ 76 comments \ @simplestacker 12 nov econ

I noticed that a lot of people on the right, hostile to the banking system, reacting badly towards the proposed idea of 50 year mortgages. They criticize it as being a boon to the banks and prolonging debt slavery.

IMO, as a bitcoiner, I am happy to take on a 50 year mortgage. Someone is essentially lending me worthless, depreciating assets (dollars) so I can use it to buy a valuable, appreciating asset (a home). Moreover, my repayment of the loan is denominated in terms of the worthless asset, so the real value of that loan is only going to go down over time.

If someone is willing to offer this to me, I don't consider myself enslaved. I consider myself lucky that someone would take the other side of that deal!!

In fact, a 50-year fixed rate mortgage (assuming it's fixed rate) probably wouldn't exist in the free-market without some sort of government backing. That should tell you that this is actually a good deal for the borrower, and not a good deal for the lender. The only reason lenders would do this is if they can offload the risk to someone else, i.e. the taxpayer.

So -- if you want to oppose 50 year mortgages, fine. But oppose it for the right reasons. Oppose it because it is a subsidy whose cost is borne by taxpayers; don't oppose it because you think it's debt slavery or a boon to banks. It's actually a boon to the borrower, and you can bet lots of savvy rich people will take advantage of it.

Why do I react so strongly about this? Because I see that this is how plebs keep themselves under the oppression of the fiat monetary system, because they don't understand finance. When I see people try to pay off their mortgages early, so they can own their home "free and clear", despite the mortgage being lower interest than what they could earn elsewhere, I shake my head. You've been given a great opportunity to denominate your debts in a rapidly devaluating asset, yet you decide to forgo the opportunity to acquire appreciating assets in order to pay down this nominal debt. It's the opposite of what rich people do, which is load up on debt to acquire assets. Stop falling for this! Realize that nominal debt denominated in dollars is debt that slowly disappears over time without you doing anything, and make smarter financial decisions.

comments

107 sats \ 2 replies \ @fishious 12 nov
Dave Ramsey In Critical Condition
After Learning Of 50-Year Mortgage



64 sats \ 1 reply \ @sha256man
12 nov

cracks knuckles
y'all already know what Jesus wud say; actually, he wud whip the usury class's asses;
[@plebpoet](#) how are my phonetics?

55 sats \ 6 replies \
@undisciplined 12 nov

Unpacking this a bit more, banks will offer these because taxpayers (who

largely overlap with homeowners) are assuming the unacceptable financial risks rather than the banks. So, 50-year mortgages are probably not a good deal for homeowners in aggregate and are a good deal for banks. What they are is good for individual homeowners, who have no power over the policy environment.

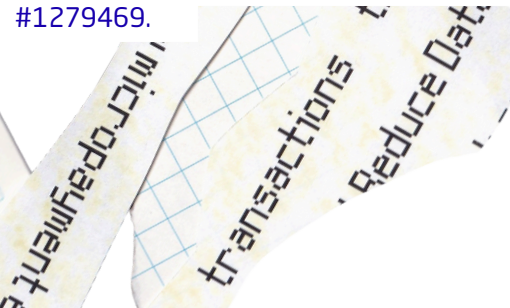
20 sats \ 5 replies \ @bitc0in 10 nov

Where
THE FUCK
Is My Meme Monday
Thread ????

memes

21 sats \ 1 reply \ @k00b 10 nov
I broke it. It'll be back next week

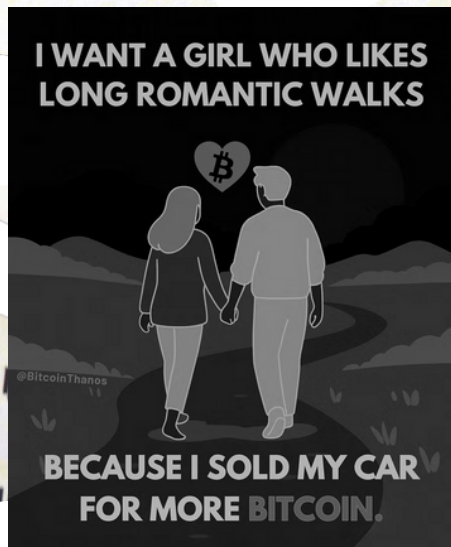
0 sats \ 0 replies \ @jinformatique 11 nov
Someone created one here, but it's not the official one, as @k00b said.
#1279469.



unofficial

Meme Monday

162 sats \ 2 comments \ @yabujin_nakamoto 10 nov memes



top art

NoGood Book update - 05 - Closing In



2334 sats \ 4 comments \ @nogood 12 nov art

Work on the NoGood Book kicked off a year ago. I've steadily shared updates on [NOSTR](#), but an update here has been long overdue; five months to the day, to be precise. What have I been up to, you ask? Let me tell you.



Over the summer I took on a few large illustration projects unrelated to NoGood. Under the NoGood moniker, I created new work for [The Sovereign Engineering Cohort](#) and [TABConf7](#). Altogether, there was little time and energy left to work on the book.

When I did find time, the book kept shapeshifting. Because I found other books that inspired me to take a different turn; because of conversations I had with [Daniël](#), my editor; or, because of the available budget. The definitive design of this book has proven illusive. I've redesigned it several times, scrapped a lot of text, only to add it back in again a month later. It went from hardcover to softcover, to hardcover, and back to softcover again (this is final, I promise). When I was happy with its pages, I changed the size of the book, forcing yet another redesign of all 272 pages. I've lost myself in the details once or twice, circling back to previous decisions and ending up elsewhere. It's not easy to design and self-publish a book, but now I think—finally—I have a good grasp of its final form.

"I love deadlines. I love the whooshing noise they make as they go by."
— Douglas Adams

keep reading online by
following this post's qr

thank you
for your participation
in my research!



Post the cover of your favorite album
836 sats \ 45 comments \ @plebpoet 11 nov music

What's your favorite album - front to back - of all time?
What's your GOAT album? Lemme see the cover. Please.
For research.

hope you're not mad

that i ripped up

ur favs

new micropayment engine

territory highlight

~Music



Meta Music Mondays came to you
with one intention. To talk music and
share tracks with each other. So let's
do that here!

Talk Music. Share Tracks. Zap Sats.

founded by @Public_N_M_E
on Tue Dec 05 2023
post cost 100 sats
reply cost 10 sats

the best



forever